The six questions we ask on the call

A 30-minute call with whoever runs operations (often the executive director or operations lead), ideally with one program staff member on the line. Each question feeds named sections of the template.

1. **What AI tools are people already using, for what, and on whose account?** Ask for the honest list, including personal accounts and free tools. Ask whether you pay for any AI features inside software you already have (email, CRM, donor database, case management). *Feeds: Tools we use; What you can use AI for.*

2. **What information do you hold about people that would hurt someone if it leaked?** Walk through donors, clients or participants, students or minors, staff and volunteers. Ask which systems hold it and whether any law or contract covers it (HIPAA, FERPA, a funder's data agreement, a government contract). *Feeds: Information that never goes into AI tools; Off limits.*

3. **Where would a mistake from AI do real harm?** Ask about anything that decides who gets help, money or a place in a program, anything sent to a funder or government agency, anything that gives medical, legal or financial guidance, and anything said publicly in the organization's name. *Feeds: Needs approval first; Decisions about people; Check everything before it goes out.*

4. **Who should say yes to something new, and who is accountable if it goes wrong?** Ask for a name or role who approves new tools and new uses, who staff tell when something goes wrong, and whether the board wants to approve the policy itself. *Feeds: Needs approval first; If something goes wrong; Who owns this policy.*

5. **What would your donors, clients and community expect you to tell them?** Ask whether they'd want to know when AI wrote a thank-you letter, a grant report, an image or a reply to a client, and whether any funder has asked about AI use. *Feeds: Being open about AI.*

6. **What worries staff, and what are they hoping AI takes off their plate?** Ask for one worry and one hope from each side if leadership and staff are both on the call. The point is to write down what both want so the policy answers it. *Feeds: Purpose; What you can use AI for; Open questions for the board.*

Anything the call doesn't settle goes into **Open questions for the board** rather than being guessed.